



Luxury watches is one of the strongest-performing categories on Tata CLiQ Luxury and continues to be a key scale driver"

GOPAL ASTHANA
CEO, TATA CLIQ LUXURY

more than ₹10 lakh.

The company has reached the ₹10-crore revenue milestone, supported by an expanding portfolio and distribution through exclusive stores, luxury hotels and premium retail partners. Its collections incorporate British-era coins, vintage stamps, Pichwai paintings, and traditional filigree work.

Bangalore Watch Company, founded by Nirupesh Joshi and his wife Mercy in 2018, is pursuing a different strategy: building an Indian independent watch brand with international appeal.

Operating primarily between $1,500 and $3,000, the company produces watches using distinctive materials such as meteorites, reclaimed aircraft metal and carbon recovered from the atmosphere.

More than half its business comes from overseas, particularly the US. The company has raised $1.4 million from 10 existing customers, including wealthy individuals and family-office principals, to finance its next stage of growth.

Joshi says the brand has already exceeded its previous year's revenue during the first half of the current financial year. It currently has annual production capacity of approximately 1,500 watches and plans to quadruple that over three years.

Rather than pursue mass distribution, the company intends to retain exclusivity with a Bengaluru flagship boutique and plans to explore international retail locations such as the UAE.

Challenges remain, including taxation, expensive luxury retail space, limited product availability, and the need for better-trained sales and servicing professionals.

The phased reduction of duties under the India-EFTA trade agreement could improve the industry's economics, although it may not automatically translate into lower retail prices.

"Pricing in India is one of the most competitive in the world because brands want the Indian market to grow. With EFTA, prices will remain the same but there will be more money for customer servicing, marketing, brand building etc.," says Saboo.

The time is right for India. BT